

This hearing has been continued to June 11, 2026.

17. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: MSC22-00088

CASE NAME: KALAMAS VS. JOHN MUIR HEALTH

***HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: FOR SANCTIONS**

FILED BY: KALAMAS, ALICIA

TENTATIVE RULING:

Plaintiff Alicia Kalamas moves for sanctions on the basis of purported misrepresentations by Defendant John Muir Health's (JMH) counsel in the Motion for Attorneys' Fees.

The Court is struggling to parse all of the alleged misrepresentations. To the best of its abilities, the Court believes the following are disputed: (1) that Plaintiff was "sanctioned" \$500,000 during the litigation; (2) that Plaintiff contradicted herself in stating the case was "not about the money" "despite asking for millions of dollars"; and (3) the motion was frivolous. On reply, Plaintiff focuses only on the last of these three issues.

It appears that Defendant was imprecise with its language regarding the "sanction." Plaintiff *was* ordered to pay fees relating to an Anti-SLAPP dismissal, *and* the judicial referee found that Plaintiff had engaged in misbehavior, but those two issues were separate. Counsel should be careful when using strong words, but this language does not rise to the level of sanctionable conduct under Code of Civil Procedure sections 128.5 and 128.7.

Although the Court does understand how a whistleblower plaintiff can seek extensive damages but also seek changes—and be willing to trade one for the other—that does not make Defendant's misunderstanding of such motivations frivolous or in bad faith.

Finally, the Court will at this point decline to find the attorneys' fees motion frivolous. The Court of Appeal is reviewing that order, and if, after appellate review, it appears that the motion was baseless, the Court may revisit it. This is not intended to encourage further motion practice in this case, but merely to note that such a determination is premature.

For these reasons, the Motion is **denied**.

Discovery Law & Motion

18. 9:01 AM CASE NUMBER: C25-00992

CASE NAME: STEVEN NEIL VS. FORD MOTOR COMPANY

***HEARING ON MOTION FOR DISCOVERY TO COMPEL FURTHER RESPONSES TO PLAINTIFFS
REQUEST FOR PRODUCTION OF DOCUMENTS, SET ONE**

FILED BY: NEIL, STEVEN D.

TENTATIVE RULING: